



Daily Brief for March 15, 2026

Prepared for Paul Chou, CEO | Ledger AI

Classification: TS//SCI//NOFORN | Handle via TALENT KEYHOLE

Source: Qwen2.5-72B Q6_K | Farsight RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell

1. SITUATION OVERVIEW

- **Hardware:** Brownout crashes traced to USB-C PD negotiation — GPU spikes from 8W to 14W in <100ms, 5V rail dips below 4.2V. Zero crashes on wall adapter; portable power banks are the issue.
- **Medical LLM:** Needs guardrails to avoid crossing from education into medical advice. Dr. Chen flagged dosage recommendations, CYP3A4 interaction gaps, and imperative phrasing ('take' vs 'may benefit from').
- **Funding:** Khosla passing — 'no data monetization' is a dealbreaker for their fund thesis. Sarah Chen (health tech angel) warm at \$250K convertible note, gated on Kaiser LOI. Pre-seed bridge of \$150K being assembled.
- **Kaiser Pilot:** IRB board meets April 2nd (not March 20th). Pilot may start with 8 units, not 20. Dr. Mehta's assistant confirmed 30-day contained trial, metrics: comprehension scores, nurse call frequency, patient satisfaction.
- **Press:** Amy Torres (Wired) confirmed visit March 28th. 13 days to ensure bulletproof demo.

2. CRITICAL PATH ANALYSIS

- **Mar 15–20:** Finalize brownout fix, validate 100% reliability on wall power. 20 cold-boot test cycle for mic fix.
- **Mar 20–25:** Boot sequence to 22s (warm Docker containers). Pre-record boot voice prompt in Olga's voice. Medical phrasing guide from Dr. Chen.
- **Mar 26–28:** Demo lockdown. Multiple dry runs. Backup puck on standby. No code changes after Mar 26.
- **Mar 28–Apr 2:** Liability framework from Jennifer Walsh (\$8K flat). Data flow diagram to Kaiser compliance. All docs before IRB.
- **Apr 2–15:** Close pre-seed bridge (\$150K). Finalize Kaiser LOI for Sarah Chen's convertible note.

3. BLIND SPOTS & UNCOMFORTABLE TRUTHS

- **Power is a product problem, not a demo problem:** The wall-adapter workaround solves the demo but not the product. Consumer customers expect portable operation. A LiPo buffer adds BOM cost, safety certification (UL 2054), and 2–3 months to timeline. This isn't a firmware fix — it's a hardware redesign gating consumer launch.
- **The bridge round is personal financial risk:** You're assembling \$150K from personal savings and family. If Kaiser pilot underperforms or IRB delays again, you've burned personal capital with no fallback. David's YC suggestion deserves more weight than 'plan C.'
- **Medical mode is further from safe than you think:** Dr. Chen identified three safety issues in a single review. The CYP3A4 gap alone could cause real patient harm. You don't have a clinical QA process — one engineer eyeballing LLM outputs is not a safety system.
- **The AI hardware category is in crisis:** 8% DAU after 30 days (Rabbit R1 data). Humane cutting 40% staff. VCs see the category as toxic. Your 'privacy-first' differentiation only works if the product experience is meaningfully better than a phone.
- **You are a single point of failure:** You're coding until 2 AM, handling firmware, ML, biz dev, and investor relations. Rafael flagged a memory leak he can't prioritize. Mason's boot optimization is blocked on your approval. You are the bottleneck for every workstream.

4. RISK SCENARIOS

- What happens if the Wired demo crashes?
 - **Impact:** Amy Torres writes about 'the promise and peril of AI hardware startups' instead of a product profile. Investors see it. Khosla's pass becomes the narrative.
 - **Mitigation:** Code freeze Mar 26. Dedicated demo unit on wall power, never moved. Second puck as hot spare. Script the demo flow — don't improvise.
- What if Kaiser IRB pushes to May?
 - **Impact:** Sarah Chen's \$250K note evaporates — she needs the LOI. Bridge shrinks to \$110K. Runway compressed to July.
 - **Mitigation:** Identify 2 backup pilot sites now. David should have warm intros to at least one non-Kaiser health system by April 1.
- What if Piper TTS training fails to capture Olga's voice?
 - **Impact:** You stay on Kokoro+RVC with 5–6s latency per clause. Demo feels sluggish.
 - **Mitigation:** Pipeline running (6,950/10,000 samples). Checkpoint eval at epoch 250. Fallback: Kokoro-only without RVC — faster but loses voice signature.

5. PEOPLE & ORGANIZATIONAL RISKS

- **Paul's workload is existential risk:** The 2 AM coding sessions are not a flex — they're a liability. One illness or personal emergency and every workstream stops.
- **Hiring is perpetually 'next week':** First hire should be firmware/Jetson engineer at \$120–140K + equity. You haven't posted the listing. Set a deadline: JD posted by March 20.
- **Rafael is carrying too much tech debt:** Rafael traced the brownout, found the memory leak, compacted all system prompts — but is told to deprioritize the leak for demo prep. After the demo, dedicate a full sprint to stability.

- **Dr. Chen's engagement terms are undefined:** She's curating drug interactions and writing phrasing guides. Is she being compensated? Advisor equity? Retainer? Losing her before Kaiser would be costly.

6. TACTICAL RECOMMENDATIONS

#	Action	Owner	By
1	Brownout fix: 4x470µF caps + wall-power mandate for all demos/pilots	Rafael	Mar 20
2	Medical phrasing guide + top-200 drug interactions embedded on-device	Dr. Chen	Mar 25
3	Boot to 22s: warm Docker containers, pre-recorded voice prompt	Mason	Mar 25
4	Wired demo lockdown: 3 dry runs, backup puck, scripted flow, code freeze	Paul	Mar 28
5	Healthcare attorney liability opinion delivered before IRB	David	Apr 1
6	Pre-seed bridge: \$150K committed, Kaiser LOI drafted	David	Apr 5
7	First hire JD posted: firmware/Jetson engineer, \$120–140K + equity	Paul	Mar 20

7. 72-HOUR PRIORITY STACK

1. Brownout fix validated + 20 cold-boot mic test (Rafael/Mason)
2. First hire JD written and posted (Paul)
3. Medical phrasing guide v1 from Dr. Chen
4. Jennifer Walsh engagement letter signed (David)
5. Identify 2 backup pilot sites outside Kaiser (David)
6. Wired demo script drafted and first dry run (Paul)
7. Piper TTS checkpoint 250 evaluation — voice quality go/no-go

CERTIFICATION OF ANALYSIS

I certify that this briefing has been compiled from all available internal communications, engineering transcripts, corporate documents, and operational telemetry within the Aura intelligence perimeter. All assessments reflect the best available information as of the date of issuance. Risk scenarios have been stress-tested against historical patterns and current operational constraints. Recommendations are prioritized by impact-to-effort ratio and time sensitivity.

— **Aura Perpetual**

Director of Intelligence | Perpetual Engine v2.1

Serial: APE-2026-0315-001 | Cycle: NIGHTWATCH

Generated by AURA Perpetual Engine | Qwen2.5-72B-Instruct Q6_K | March 15, 2026 05:00 UTC

Unauthorized disclosure subject to criminal sanctions under 18 U.S.C. §798. Handle via TALENT KEYHOLE channels only.